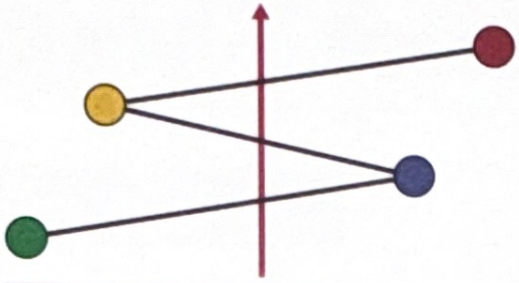


Culture Index™

Analytics Over Instincts

The Philosopher

The Philosopher is an independent person that is distinct with their opinions and conduct. Research persistent, this person strives on thinking and staying in a cerebral and imaginative environment as much as possible. A true "ideas" person, this is out-of-the-box thinking at its best.

Very inward in their thinking, the Philosopher is the consummate analytical type. They like to take their time internalizing and debating the value of their ideas and the ideas of others. While it can be perceived by others that the Philosopher can be argumentative, others need to recognize that this person is a non-conformist. If you say it's black, they will say it's white. The interpretation of that argument is simply, *"If you dictate or attempt to make me obey or agree, I will argue back. Whether my argument makes sense to you, the disagreement will occur because I am naturally rebellious when it comes to conformity."*

Laid back and easy going, they give a great deal of consideration to most everything including challenges and problem solving. They are a great resource, and as a "go-to" person, there isn't much they can't solve or troubleshoot. However, they will not give much thought to follow through once something has been implemented.

What captivates their attention is to stay in the big picture. To have to go backwards in time or recall an event that took place several weeks ago will make them insolent to deal with, because recollection isn't one of their strong natural abilities.

Casual in their communication style, they can be entertaining, as they have a way with words. Factual in nature, they have a knack for embellishment and can wander off from the subject at hand. They communicate their ideas with strong conviction, and will come across as being obstinate and opinionated. They will voice offhand remarks from time to time and will not think to take into consideration the viewpoint or thoughts of others.

Unconventional, informal and uninhibited, the Philosopher is somewhat fearless in their decision making. As a result, they can appear to be rash in their assessment. Others may think the decision wasn't thought all the way through, and that would be true.

FlashPoints

Motivation

- Independence
- Private Recognition
- Goal Setting

Communication

- Laid Back
- Conceptual
- Email Preferred

Management

- Absentee
- Autocratic
- Few Direct Reports

Organization | Environment

- Unstructured
- Steady Pace
- Quiet

The Philosopher Continued

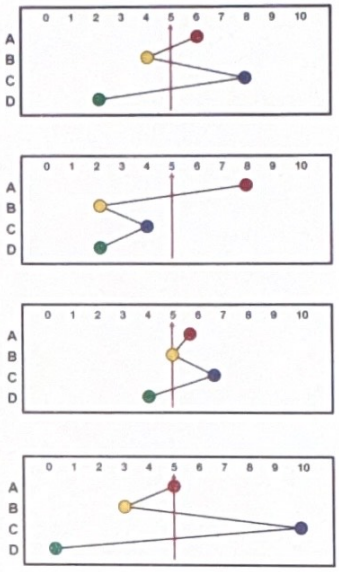
Best working with singular projects as opposed to tasks, time tables need to be defined, as this person will procrastinate. Even though they don't like rules and authority, they need to understand the terms of their responsibility in order to complete the project on a timely basis.

The Philosopher's pace at the workplace is steady and deliberate. Management would do best with this person by providing them a receptive environment for their ideas, as some of them can be profound. They will work with others, but prefer to strike off on their own. Not a team player and not wanting to be a team leader, they have little regard for the conventional ways of doing things. The Philosopher can be perceived as aloof and indifferent if the subject is of little value to them.

Keep in mind, some out-of-the-box thinking can provide solutions that may be unusual or untypical. Where the Philosophers excel is when they can give deliberate thought and innovative thinking towards the problem or goal at hand, as that's what they do best.

Motivation and rewards need to be done on a one-on-one level with consideration given to individual interests.

Several Variations



In Summary

Motivating Needs & Rewards

The Philosopher requires freedom and independence to think. A private person, they prefer acknowledgments that come in the form of what they determine to be a personal reward.

Communication Style

Can be easy to understand one minute, then cerebral or conceptually vague the next. You will need to ask them specifically what you want answered and try again. Email rather than voicemail.

Management Style

They are great as a go-to resource; however, once a solution has been provided, they will not remember to follow through unless the situation is critical. Their style is not motivational, it's more autocratic.

Organization Style

Loose and unstructured.

Environmental Needs

If you attempt to micro-manage the Philosopher, you will learn how disagreeable they can be. They prefer an easy going pace that is project oriented with people available for delegation. They are not task oriented.